

Case Study

Financial Management App

by **w1** Consultoria



w1

Home screen

Opportunity for improvement

The position of the “Don’t show this again” feature makes it easy for the user to trigger it by accident when trying to leave that screen, since it sits too close to the Home Indicator. According to Nielsen’s Heuristics — specifically **Heuristic 5** (Error Prevention) — this placement is not ideal, because being so close to the Home Indicator increases the chance of a wrong tap. This can cause unnecessary frustration and affect how smooth the experience feels.



Suggestion

A good solution would be to move the “Start” and “Cancel” buttons higher up, closer to the “Don’t show this again” option, keeping them centered. This would prevent unnecessary frustration and create a smoother experience, following Nielsen’s Heuristic on error prevention.

Statement

Opportunity — visible balance

Showing the account balance is hard to reach in terms of mobile usability, especially for left-handed users. Some information does belong at the top, but for something checked every day, this isn't the best placement. This goes against the Thumb Zone study by Apple founder Steve Jobs, which recommends keeping buttons and menus within easy reach.

Opportunity — income/expense indicator

The income/expense component uses a small arrow for each movement, but they're hard to tell apart at a glance — an inconsistency with Nielsen's **Heuristic 1** (visibility of system status). Users should read information quickly, without extra effort. Distinct colors would make the interface easier to understand.



Suggestion — visible balance

A good solution would be to move it further down the screen, so it's within easy reach for both right- and left-handed users, without asking them to make an extra effort that could hurt usability.

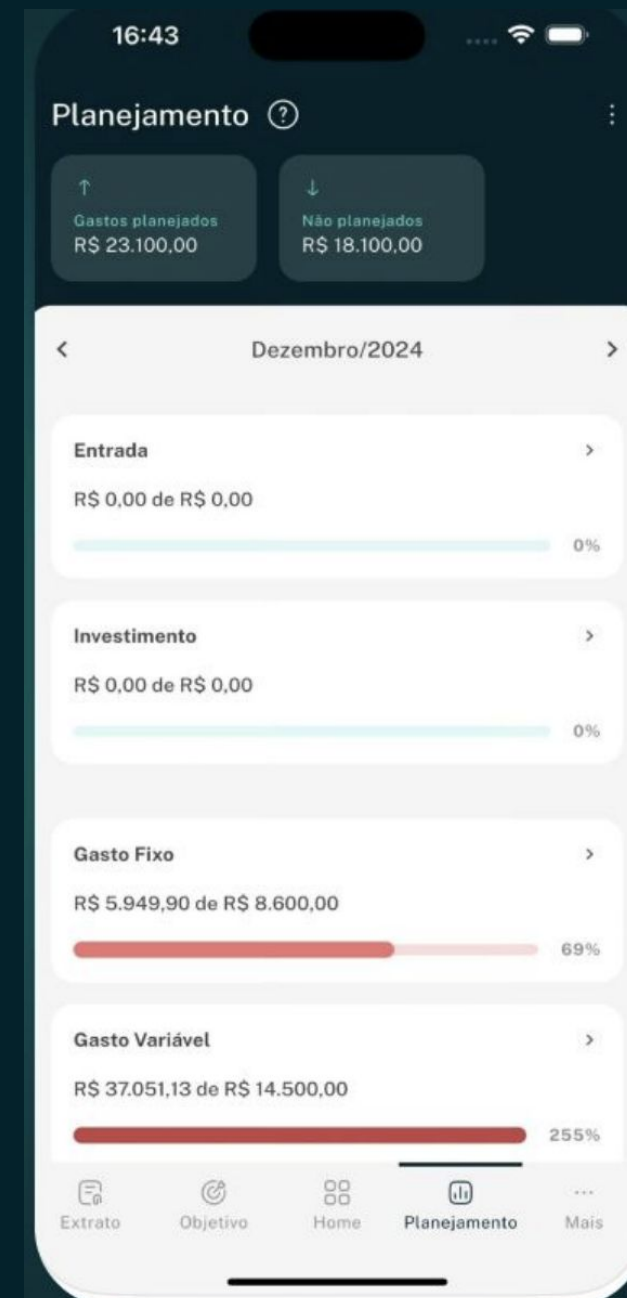
Suggestion — income/expense indicator

Color-coding the arrows would help, following Heuristic 1. Income could be shown in blue and expenses in red, so users spot financial movements at a glance without extra reading, making navigation clearer.

Planning

Opportunity — add a plan

On the Planning screen, it isn't clear where the user can add a new plan. Each category — Income, Investment, Fixed and Variable Expense — has a small arrow that presumably leads elsewhere. Based on Nielsen's **Heuristic 4** (consistency and standards), "Add Plan" should match the pattern of "Add Goal" and "Add Transaction." Heuristic 6 also states that users should recognize rather than recall — the missing pattern here can break the flow between screens and, in some cases, lead to frustration and app abandonment.



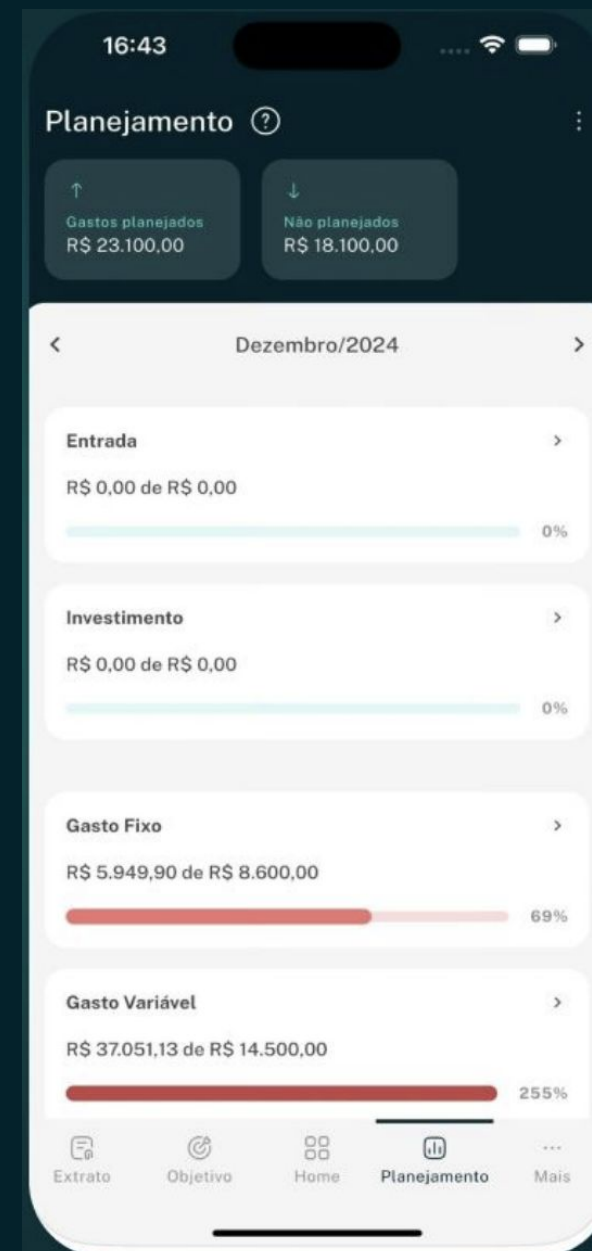
Suggestion — add a plan

Standardizing the buttons — "Add Plan," "Add Goal" and "Add Transaction" — would make the app more intuitive, helping users recognize actions instead of recalling them, per Heuristic 6. Consistency (Heuristic 4) would also help users quickly understand how to interact with each element, reducing cognitive effort. For the team, unifying these patterns would lower development and maintenance cost while improving satisfaction.

Planning

Opportunity — income/expense component

The planned/unplanned expenses component uses a different layout than the equivalent one on the Statement page, even though both serve the same purpose. This conflicts with Nielsen's **Heuristic 4**. It also costs the dev team time to build and maintain two approaches. Heuristic 6 makes this worse: without a pattern, navigation feels less intuitive.



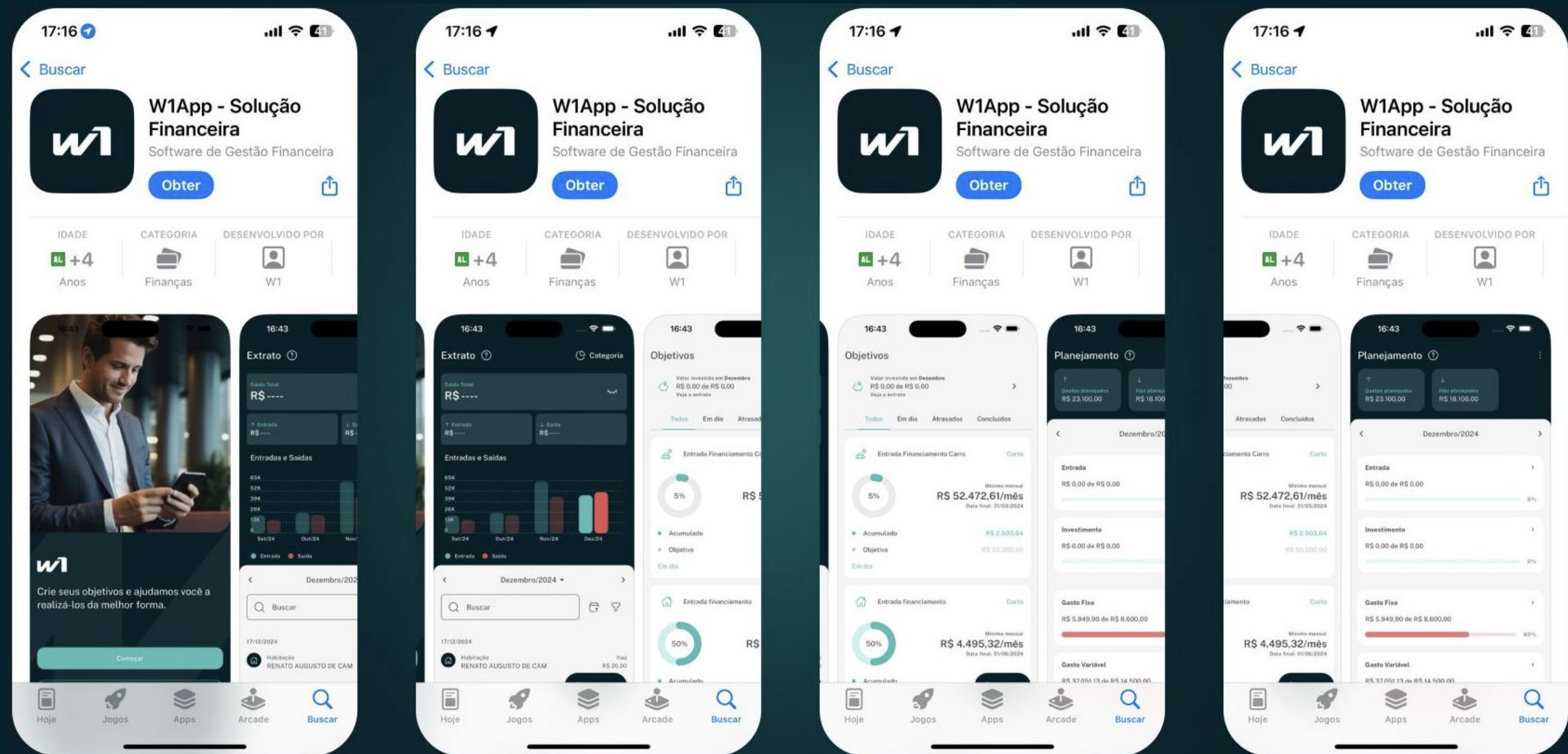
Suggestion — income/expense component

Aligning this component with the Statement page's layout would make navigation more intuitive, per Heuristic 4. Applying Heuristic 6, standardizing it would make the app easier to use. For the team, reusable, consistent components reduce build and maintenance complexity, optimizing development time and cost.

Benchmarking

	M Mobills	O Organizze	\$ Minhas Economias	W WalletApp
Create category	✓	✓	✓	✓
Create tags	\$	✓	✓	✓
Dark mode	✓	✓	✓	
Fixed income/expense	✓	✓	✓	✓
Recurring transaction	✓	✓	✓	
Link to card	\$		\$	\$
Save and continue	✓	✓	✓	✓
Set a plan	\$		✓	✓
Create subcategory	\$	✓	✓	✓
Bank import	✓		✓	✓
Export reports	\$		\$	
Attachments on entries	✓	✓	✓	✓
Add card statement with start & due dates	✓	✓	✓	
Choose currency	✓		✓	✓
Log income/expense not yet paid or received	✓	✓	✓	✓
Travel mode	\$		✓	

Sources



Reference: W1App – Financial Solution — Apple App Store listing (Finance category, developed by W1)